Genetically modified food

In agriculture, crops may be engineered to enhance them in some way. A genetically altered crop is known as a genetically modified organism (GMO). Companies that operate in this sector may modify a plant's DNA so that it produces more of a certain nutrient or a toxin specific to a particular insect pest. The DNA of a plant may also be altered to become resistant to a particular herbicide, so that use of the chemical kills only the weeds and not the crop.

Some ecologists argue that there is a risk of genetically unmodified plants becoming contaminated by GMOs. They also point out that the long-term effects of eating such foods are as yet not properly understood. Another concern is that in the future large agrochemical companies could control the world's food supply by patenting the GMOs that they produce, to the detriment of poorer nations.